

Glossary of Terms

AGTTM Part 1: Introduction (Pages 13-17)

Term	Description
85th percentile	The speed at or below which 85% of vehicles are observed to travel under free-flowing conditions past a nominated point.
AADT	see annual average daily traffic
AGTTM	Austroroads Guide to Temporary Traffic Management
adjacent clearance area	The area immediately adjacent to the traffic lane, and typically between the traffic lane and the worksite that should be kept free from features that would be potentially hazardous to errant vehicles.
advance warning area	Area in advance of the worksite where advance warning traffic control devices are erected to warn and inform of changes to traffic conditions ahead and to give road users time to adjust their driving behaviour.
advance warning distance	Distance measured between successive signs in the advance warning area and the distance from the beginning of the taper or closure or work area to the first advance sign.
annual average daily traffic	The total volume of traffic passing a roadside observation point over the period of a calendar year, divided by the number of days in that year (365 or 366 days).
around the worksite	Methods of hazard elimination, when the entire work area (including all vehicles and plant) is located 6 m or more clear from the nearest edge of a traffic lane.
arterial road	A road that predominantly carries through traffic from one region to another, forming principal avenues of travel for traffic movements. Sub-definitions: Rural - A general term for the main road carrying mostly long-distance traffic, as distinct from local traffic. Urban - A general term for a main traffic route, but specifically referring to certain streets so designated in a local authority's district scheme.
AS	Australian Standard
AS/NZS	Australian / New Zealand Standard
auxiliary lane	A portion of the roadway adjoining the through traffic lanes, used for speed change or for other purposes supplementary to through traffic movement.
B-double	A combination consisting of a prime mover towing two semitrailers, with the first semitrailer being attached directly to the prime mover by a fifth wheel coupling and the second semitrailer being mounted on the rear of the first semitrailer by a fifth wheel coupling on the first semitrailer.
B-triple	A prime mover towing three semitrailers. The first and second semitrailers are connected to the following semitrailer by a fifth wheel permanently located toward the rear of the semitrailer. Under the Heavy Vehicle National Law, a B-triple is categorised as a road train.
barricade	Barricades comprise either barrier boards or stand-alone non-interconnected lightweight modules. They must be used to inhibit access to a work area.
barrier board	Boards 150 mm to 200 mm in height and not more than 4 m in length. They are mounted on trestles or fixed posts at about 1 m above the pavement. The colour combination used for barrier boards must be alternate diagonal stripes of black and retroreflective yellow, terminating in yellow at each end.
barrier line	A pair of longitudinal lines marked on the roadway to prohibit overtaking movement in one or both directions.
buffer zone	An advance warning area if speed on the approach to a temporary speed zone is more than 30 km/h higher than the temporary speed limit and needs to be reduced in stages.
built-up area	In relation to a length of road, means an area in which either of the following is present for a distance of at least 500 metres, for the whole of the road: buildings, not over 100 metres apart on land next to the road and/or street lights not over 100 metres apart (see urban road) or, if the length of road is shorter than 500 metres.

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centreline	The line which defines the axis or alignment of the centre of a road or other work. In relation to any portion of a roadway not marked with a flush median - a dotted or solid line or lines of paint or raised studs (or any combination of those lines or studs) intended to separate opposing traffic. In relation to any portion of a roadway marked with a flush median - the longitudinal white line that forms the left side of the median as viewed by a driver facing forward. In relation to an unmarked roadway - the inferred line down the longitudinal centre of the roadway.
chicane	The lateral movement of traffic from one or more lanes onto another alignment before a shift back toward the original road alignment but not necessarily into the original lane or lanes. Typically applied to reduce the speed of traffic.
closure	The physical area from which the road users are to be excluded. This includes but is not limited to shoulder closures, lane closures and road closures.
competent person	A person who has, through a combination of training, qualification and experience, acquired knowledge and skills enabling that person to correctly perform a specified task.
containment fence	Physical barrier sufficient to provide separation between the travelled path, or paths used by cyclists and pedestrians, from the work area, but not as rigid as to become a hazard if struck by vehicles, or to act as a safety barrier.
contractor	A person, organisation or company responsible for implementation of an activity on or affecting a road. Examples include but are not limited to construction and maintenance crews, utility companies, surveyors, filming crews and event management.
contraflow	Traffic flow in a direction opposite to the normal flow, where two-way flow is maintained at all times. Contraflow divided by permanent rigid safety barriers or with median widths of 6 m or more use around the worksite methods. Contraflow divided by a double barrier line or with median widths of less than 6 m use past the worksite methods.
detour	A temporary, alternative route to guide road users around a worksite operation, most commonly during temporary closure of a road or path.
divided road	A road with separate roadways for traffic travelling in opposite directions.
dividing line	A road marking formed by a line, or two parallel lines, whether broken or continuous, designed to indicate the parts of the road to be used by vehicles travelling in opposite directions.
double barrier line	see barrier line
dynamic deflection	The largest transverse deflection of a road safety barrier system during an actual crash or during a full-scale impact test (i.e. the amount the road safety barrier deflects from its initial position during impact).
emergency services	An entity that has a statutory responsibility to respond to an emergency and includes the following: an ambulance service, a fire brigade (including a volunteer fire brigade), a police force or police service, a disaster or emergency organisation of the Commonwealth or a State or Territory.
flare (road safety barrier)	The change in the offset of a road safety barrier to move it further from the travelled way or closer to the travelled way.
gore	A triangular area where two roads either meet or split.
hazard (roadside)	Any object or feature located between the edge of a traffic lane and the road reserve boundary, or within a median, that could cause significant personal injury (including fatal injury) to road users when impacted by an errant vehicle.
intersection	The place at which two or more roads meet or cross.
lane line	A line (usually painted), other than the centreline, that divides adjacent traffic lanes travelling in the same direction. This line is usually painted but may be raised delineating devices.
long term	The description which applies when a traffic guidance scheme is required to operate both day and night and may be left unattended.
may	Indicates the existence of an option

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median	A strip of road, not normally intended for use by traffic, which separates carriageways for traffic in opposite directions. Usually formed by painted lines, kerbed and paved areas, grassed areas, etc.
mobile work	Work that entails vehicles moving progressively along the roadway at speeds significantly lower than other traffic, with all traffic control devices being either vehicle mounted or regularly moved along the road.
motorway	A divided highway, freeway, expressway, controlled access highway etc. for through traffic with no access for traffic between interchanges and with grade separation at some interchanges. Certain activities or uses may be restricted or prohibited by legislative provision.
multilane	Two or more running lanes in one direction.
must	Indicates that a statement is mandatory
off-peak period	The periods that have low demand volumes of traffic during the day (see peak period).
offset speed zone	Temporary speed zones which result in speed limits which are different for each direction of travel at a particular location.
open road area	Roadside development less frequent than that specified for a built-up area (see built-up area).
past the worksite	Methods of hazard control, when the entire work area (including all vehicles and plant) is located within 6 m from the nearest edge of a traffic lane.
peak period	The period that has the highest demand volume of traffic and/or number of passengers during the day (peak hour, peak half hour, etc.) (see off-peak period).
permanent speed limit	The maximum legal speed limit for a specific section of road indicated by permanent speed limit signs. These signs are in place 24 hours a day, seven days a week and have been implemented after a speed limit review has been carried out.
portable traffic control device	An approved portable device used to control traffic to enhance the safety and protection of road users and road workers at the worksite, specifically an option to improve safety for traffic controllers. Portable traffic controller devices may include PTSS or boom barriers.
portable traffic signal systems	An approved portable traffic signal device allowing traffic controllers to perform their roles at a safe distance from traffic in high risk environments.
primary sign	The first sign closest to the worksite, work area or hazard. This sign is followed by repeater signs placed further from the worksite, work area or hazard.
PTCD	see portable traffic control device
PTSS	see portable traffic signal systems
road reserve	An area of land between the legal road boundaries, usually a fence line to fence line. This typically includes the roadway, footpaths, other access ways and unpaved areas, which are dedicated to allow the passage of road users. The road reserve also includes an airspace of six metre directly above the road surface.
road safety barrier system	A physical barrier separating the work area and the travelled path, designed to resist penetration by an errant vehicle and as far as reasonably practicable, to redirect errant vehicles back into the travelled path.
road train	A combination, other than a B-double, consisting of a motor vehicle towing at least two trailers, excluding any converter dolly supporting a semitrailer.
road user	Any driver, rider, passenger or pedestrian using the road.
roadway	Any one part of the width of a road devoted particularly to the use of vehicles, inclusive of shoulders and auxiliary lanes.
running lane	The portion of the roadway allotted for the use of a single line of vehicles. Cyclists operating in these lanes are considered vehicles.
rural road	A general term for the road carrying mostly long-distance traffic, as distinct from local traffic and located in open road areas.

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safety buffer	The unoccupied space between the additional warning area and work area which allows for an errant vehicle to pull up before reaching the work area.
safe work method statement	A document which identifies the type of work being undertaken, the risks, the hazards and controls to be implemented to eliminate the risk.
short term (traffic control)	Description that applies when a traffic guidance scheme is required only while work personnel are in attendance, and is generally limited to the duration of a single work shift.
should	Indicates a recommendation
shoulder	A sealed or unsealed part of the road outside the edge line, or inferred edge line, which is trafficable, adjacent to the traffic lane and flush with the surface of the pavement.
shuttle flow	Where a portion of the roadway is closed so that a single lane is used alternately by traffic from opposite directions. It is one-way flow with one direction first, then the other. This is used where insufficient width is available for maintaining two-way flow at all times.
shuttle lane	The lane that is open to traffic in a shuttle flow temporary traffic management arrangement
sight distance	The distance, measured along the road over which visibility occurs between a driver or rider and an object or between two drivers at specific heights above the roadway in their lane of travel.
speed	Distance travelled per unit of time (km per hour).
speed of traffic (traffic speed)	The posted speed limit at a location when being adhered to by the majority of road users (see 85th percentile). This can be checked by travelling in the stream of vehicles and comparing to the posted speed limit. If the speed of the majority of vehicles are travelling significantly slower or faster than the posted speed limit (+/-10 km/h), apply this speed limit when making any decisions regarding design.
static works	All works which are greater in scope and duration than can be handled by short term, low impact methods or mobile works and are contained within a fixed area.
swept path	The area bounded by lines traced by the extremities of the bodywork of a vehicle while turning.
SWMS	see safe work method statement
taper	A straight or smoothly curved row of delineation devices used to shift traffic laterally, e.g. from a lane to the shoulder.
temporary speed limit	A speed limit that is applied on some sections of road as a result of roadworks, school zones or other variable speed limits which are in place to suit driving and travel conditions. These are not permanent speed limits.
termination area	Where road users have passed the work area and normal traffic conditions resume.
TGS	see traffic guidance schemes
through the worksite	Methods of hazard separation by stopping all road user's movement for short periods when workers need to occupy the roadway.
TMA	see truck mounted attenuator
TMP	see traffic management plan
traffic	All vehicles or persons travelling on a road unless the context indicates otherwise.
traffic controller	A competent person whose duty it is to control traffic at a worksite.
traffic control device	Any traffic sign, road marking, traffic signal, or other device, placed or erected under public authority for the purpose of regulating, directing, warning or guiding traffic.
traffic guidance schemes	An arrangement of temporary traffic control devices to warn traffic and guide it around, through or past a worksite or temporary hazard.
traffic management plan	A document describing all essential traffic management matters associated with roadworks or works on roads. This includes risk assessment, traffic demand and accommodation, traffic routing and control and provision for vulnerable road users and special vehicles such as buses, trams or over-dimensional vehicles.

Term	Description
traffic speed	see speed of traffic
travelled path	That part of the roadway which is made available to vehicles and which may consist of one or more running lanes.
truck mounted attenuator	A safety device designed to reduce the severity of collision that should be fitted to slow moving or stationary work vehicles which are exposed to potential impact from behind by approaching traffic.
two-way roadway	A roadway having running lanes allotted for use by traffic in opposing directions.
undivided road	A road without a median (see divided road).
unsealed road	A road that does not have a hard or smooth surface. Unsealed road surfaces include gravel, sand or dirt.
variable message sign	Variable message signs can be changed to display information messages to alert drivers of on-road incidents on the road ahead. They are also used to warn road users about weather conditions and other important information.
vehicles per day	The number of vehicles observed passing a point in both directions on a road for 24 hours.
vehicles per hour	The number of vehicles observed passing a point in both directions on a road for one hour.
VMS	see variable message sign
vpd	see vehicles per day
vph	see vehicles per hour
vulnerable road user	Pedestrians, cyclists, motorcyclists.
work area	Area where maintenance or construction work is being done.
worksite	An area which includes the work area(s) and any additional length of road required for advance signing, tapers, sidetracks or other areas needed for associated purposes.